



TOP OF THE CHARTS

The top 10 advertisers in cricket since 2014

Coca-Cola India

Vishnu Packaging

Reckitt Benckiser (India)

Parle Agro

K.P. Pan Foods

Parle Products

Britannia Industries

Asian Paints

Kent RO Systems

Bharti Airtel

Source: TAM Sports

TEAM SPIRIT

The amount of money generated when licensing an IPL team franchise has skyrocketed since the tournament began in 2008

306



Kolkata Knight Riders

310



Punjab Kings*

342



Delhi Capitals

371



Chennai Super Kings

436



Sunrisers Hyderabad**

455



Royal Challengers Bangalore

456



Mumbai Indians

5,625



Gujarat Titans#

7,090



Lucknow Super Giants#

Amount in ₹ crore generated by the auction of IPL team franchises; *then called Kings XI Punjab; **formerly Deccan Chargers; #team franchises auctioned in 2022

Source: Treelife report on IPL

apart from a presence in segments like ready-to-drink beverages, bar snacks and edtech," he says. Its other forays include fitness, the Women's Premier League and gaming.

If RCB has been around since the first season in 2008, last year's winner and first-time entrant, Gujarat Titans, too is looking at the IPL with a long-term lens. "A season-to-season approach is not the way to do it. We have our plans in place for the next three to five years," says the team's COO, Arvinder Singh. Winning in the year it debuted has helped the cause. "It has helped us leapfrog but we still need to be relevant through the year. There is a lot of headroom for growth and our goal is to be the most entertaining franchise."

In many ways, the maturity of a tournament is reflected in the changing nature of its ownership, more specifically, the ownership of its teams. "In the initial phase, we had celebrities and over time, the likes of a CVC (a Europe-based private equity firm) have come in as the owner of Gujarat Titans. The glamour quotient has faded away, making way for a more professional structure," says Ajimon Francis, MD of Brand Finance India, an international brand valuation firm. He adds that the IPL has shown the way for the volleyball